

Tamil Nadu – Information and Publicity Department (DIPR)

Latest Information, Press Releases, Minister Statements, Government Communications, Media & Publications, Video/Photo Archive, and Announcements

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Based on publicly available sources up to this date

1. Department Overview

The Information and Publicity Department of Tamil Nadu functions through the Directorate of Information and Public Relations (DIPR). It is the nodal agency for:

- Official government communication and publicity
- Press releases and media coordination
- Public information campaigns on welfare schemes and policies
- Fact-checking and countering misinformation
- Maintaining government media archives (video, photo, publications)

The department operates under the Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, and Information and Publicity.

2. Current Minister and Portfolio (2026)

- Minister: A. Rajmohan (TVK)
- Portfolio: School Education, Tamil Development, and Information and Publicity
- Appointment: Since the TVK cabinet formation in May 2026, under Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay.

Key responsibilities linked to this portfolio include:

- Official language (Tamil) promotion and policy
 - Government press, stationery, and printing
 - Film technology, cinematograph regulations, and newsprint control
 - Oversight of DIPR and related communication units
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3. Latest Structural Changes (2026)

3.1 Information Integrity Desk (IID)

- In August 2026, the Tamil Nadu government renamed the Tamil Nadu Fact Check Unit as the "Information Integrity Desk (IID)".

- Head of IID: Guru (Guru Thalaiva), TVK's social media head and founder of the Online Thalapathy Fans Club.
- Core mandate: Identify misinformation and manipulated content; verify claims against official sources; publish evidence-based fact checks; contain panic and false narratives before they spread widely.

3.2 Ticket-Based Fact-Check Tracking

- IID uses a Ticket-Based Tracking System: each fact-check request gets a unique ticket ID; the ticket logs source of claim, assigned fact-checker, concerned department, nodal officer, and department response. Aim: accountability, transparency, traceability, and auditability.
- Response SLAs: High priority within 1 hour; Medium priority within 3 hours; Low priority within 7 hours.
- Each department has a nodal officer linked to IID via a dedicated WhatsApp group; departments are expected to respond even outside office hours.

3.3 Social Media Desk under DIPR

A separate Social Media Desk has been set up under DIPR with a six-tier hierarchy:

- 1 DIPR Director
- 2 Joint Director (Social Media)
- 3 Public Relations Officer
- 4 Special Officer – Dhivya (TVK IT wing coordinator), who also acts as the quality clearance point before content is published
- 5 Senior Programme Coordinators and Writers
- 6 Technical Assistants and Graphic Designers

This desk handles official social media content across platforms and coordinates with IID on fact-checks.

4. Press Releases and Official Announcements

4.1 Government Press Releases (General)

Official press releases and announcements from the Tamil Nadu government are disseminated through:

- DIPR channels (website, social media, press notes to media)
- Lok Bhavan (Governor's Secretariat) for governor-related press releases
- Department-specific websites for scheme launches and policy updates

Recent examples of press-release-type content include:

- Governor's messages on Independence Day 2026 and other state events
- Announcements on census self-enumeration, university convocations, and state-level competitions
- Government resolutions (e.g., Assembly resolution on the FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026) moved by Minister Rajmohan

4.2 Where to Find Press Releases

Key official sources:

- TN DIPR official channels (YouTube, X/Twitter, Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp) – for video press briefings, scheme announcements, and campaign launches
 - Lok Bhavan, Tamil Nadu – Governor's press releases: <https://lokbhavan.tn.gov.in/category/press-release/>
 - News portals often carry verbatim statements and government press notes, especially for major policy moves and minister comments.
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5. Minister Statements (Information & Publicity Portfolio)

Minister A. Rajmohan has made several public statements relevant to the Information and Publicity function and broader communication policy:

5.1 On "Tamil Thai Vaazhthu" Protocol

- In July 2026, Minister Rajmohan reaffirmed that "Tamil Thai Vaazhthu" will continue to be given first place at all state government events, even if some functions (like university convocations in the presence of the Governor) have rendered it after the National Anthem and Vande Mataram.
- He cited past precedents at Annamalai University and Lok Bhavan functions to explain that variations in protocol have occurred earlier as well.

5.2 On Government Communication and "Reels" Criticism

- In August 2026, after AIADMK leader Edappadi Palaniswami criticised the TVK government for allegedly focusing on "reels" instead of real work, Minister Rajmohan responded that it is the people who are making reels, wanting change and improvement, and highlighted closure of 717 TASMACH shops, enhancement of pensions for freedom fighters, and anti-corruption measures as the government's real achievements.

5.3 On False Propaganda and Political Attacks

- Minister Rajmohan has also publicly alleged "deliberate and malicious" false propaganda against certain ministers (e.g., Minister Keerthana) and defended the government's actions, including withdrawal of certain cases, as part of a broader clean-governance push.

5.4 On Language and Education Policy (Linked to Information Role)

- He has reiterated the state's two-language policy (Tamil and English) in schools and opposition to any three-language formula.
 - He has also announced plans for a committee of retired judges and educationists to examine complaints of exorbitant fees in private schools.
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6. Government Communication and Campaigns

6.1 Welfare Schemes and Policy Announcements

- DIPR's official YouTube channel and social media accounts are used to announce new welfare schemes, explain eligibility and application processes, and share success stories and beneficiary testimonials.
- Example: Campaigns around "Drug Free Tamil Nadu", including large-scale pledge events and award ceremonies, have been widely covered via DIPR's video channels.

6.2 Fact-Checking and Misinformation Control

- The Information Integrity Desk (IID) receives claims from the public, media, and departments; verifies them using official data and documents; publishes fact-checks with evidence and sources; and uses a ticketing system to track each case and ensure timely response.

6.3 Public Awareness and Behavioural Campaigns

Campaign themes include:

- Anti-drug and de-addiction awareness
 - Census participation and self-enumeration
 - Education reforms, NEET opposition, and student support
 - Tamil language promotion and cultural events (e.g., "Madras on Stage" photo exhibit, Chennai Day celebrations)
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7. Media and Publications

7.1 Government Publications

- Official brochures, pamphlets, and reports on schemes and policies are produced under the Stationery and Printing vertical linked to the Information portfolio.
- These are often distributed through government offices and district collectorates; schools, colleges, and public institutions; and online portals and DIPR media kits for journalists.

7.2 Engagement with Traditional Media

- DIPR coordinates press conferences and media briefings, distribution of press notes to newspapers, TV channels, and radio, and special features on government achievements and flagship schemes.
 - Events such as the "Madras on Stage" photo exhibit have been used to highlight cultural and media heritage, with Minister Rajmohan speaking on the legacy of institutions like The Hindu.
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8. Video and Photo Archive

8.1 Official Video Archive (TN DIPR YouTube)

Channel: "TN DIPR" – Official YouTube Channel of the Tamil Nadu Government Information and Public Relations Department

Content includes Chief Minister's speeches and event coverage; departmental campaign videos (e.g., Drug Free Tamil Nadu); scheme launch videos, public messages, and anniversary/celebration clips (e.g., Chennai

Day greetings).

Channel link: <https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCPWnoINnA43mptLCQH9B9qw>

8.2 Social Media Photo/Video Repositories

DIPR maintains official presence on:

- X (Twitter): <https://x.com/TNDIPRNEWS>
- Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/share/1CFFTdrjUP/>
- Instagram: www.instagram.com/tndipr
- WhatsApp Channel: for broadcast updates

These platforms serve as a living archive of event photographs, infographics on schemes, and short videos and reels highlighting government work.

8.3 Photo Exhibits and Cultural Documentation

- Events like the "Madras on Stage" photo exhibit in Chennai have been used to document and showcase the city's cultural and media history, with ministerial participation and official coverage.

9. Recent Announcements and Key Updates (2026)

- Renaming of Fact Check Unit to Information Integrity Desk (IID) and appointment of Guru Thalaiva as its head (August 2026).
- Creation of a dedicated Social Media Desk under DIPR with Dhivya as Special Officer for content quality clearance (August 2026).
- Reaffirmation that "Tamil Thai Vaazhthu" will retain first place at state government events (July 2026).
- Tamil Nadu Assembly resolution on the FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026, moved by Minister Rajmohan, expressing concern over its impact on NGOs and civil society (August 2026).
- Public statements defending government performance against criticism that it focuses only on "reels", highlighting concrete anti-corruption and welfare measures (August 2026).
- Governor's press releases on Independence Day 2026, census self-enumeration, and other state-level initiatives (July–August 2026).

10. Source Websites and Official Links

Use these as primary sources for the latest information, press releases, and archives:

- 1 TN DIPR – Official YouTube Channel

<https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCPWnoINnA43mptLCQH9B9qw>

Latest government videos, campaign films, event coverage

- 1 TN DIPR – Social Media

X (Twitter): <https://x.com/TNDIPRNEWS>

Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/share/1CFFTdrjUP/>

Instagram: www.instagram.com/tndipr

WhatsApp Channel: link shared via DIPR posts

1 Lok Bhavan, Tamil Nadu – Press Releases (Governor)

<https://lokbhavan.tn.gov.in/category/press-release/>

Governor's messages, event press releases, official greetings

1 News Coverage of DIPR and Minister Statements

The Hindu, The New Indian Express, DT Next, Dinamani, TamilURL, etc., for detailed reports on minister statements, policy changes, and IID restructuring

Note: The main DIPR website URL may change with government web restructuring; the YouTube and social media links above are the most consistently updated public-facing channels as of August 2026.